

Socio-political environment of business

Session 5. The Opportunities and Risks of Technology; focus theme: platform capitalism and the gig economy.

Today:

- Opportunities and Risks of Technology – general introduction
- Two examples on opportunities and risks of digital technology:
 1. Platform Capitalism through the example of Social Media
 2. The Gig Economy through the example of the on-demand delivery sector.

Do Good. Do Better.

**What are the opportunities and risks of
technology for our world, societies and
lives?**

(re)Thinking technology

Intrinsically, technology is neither good nor bad—it is the use to which it is put that makes the difference. = e.g. film on “Slaughterbots”.

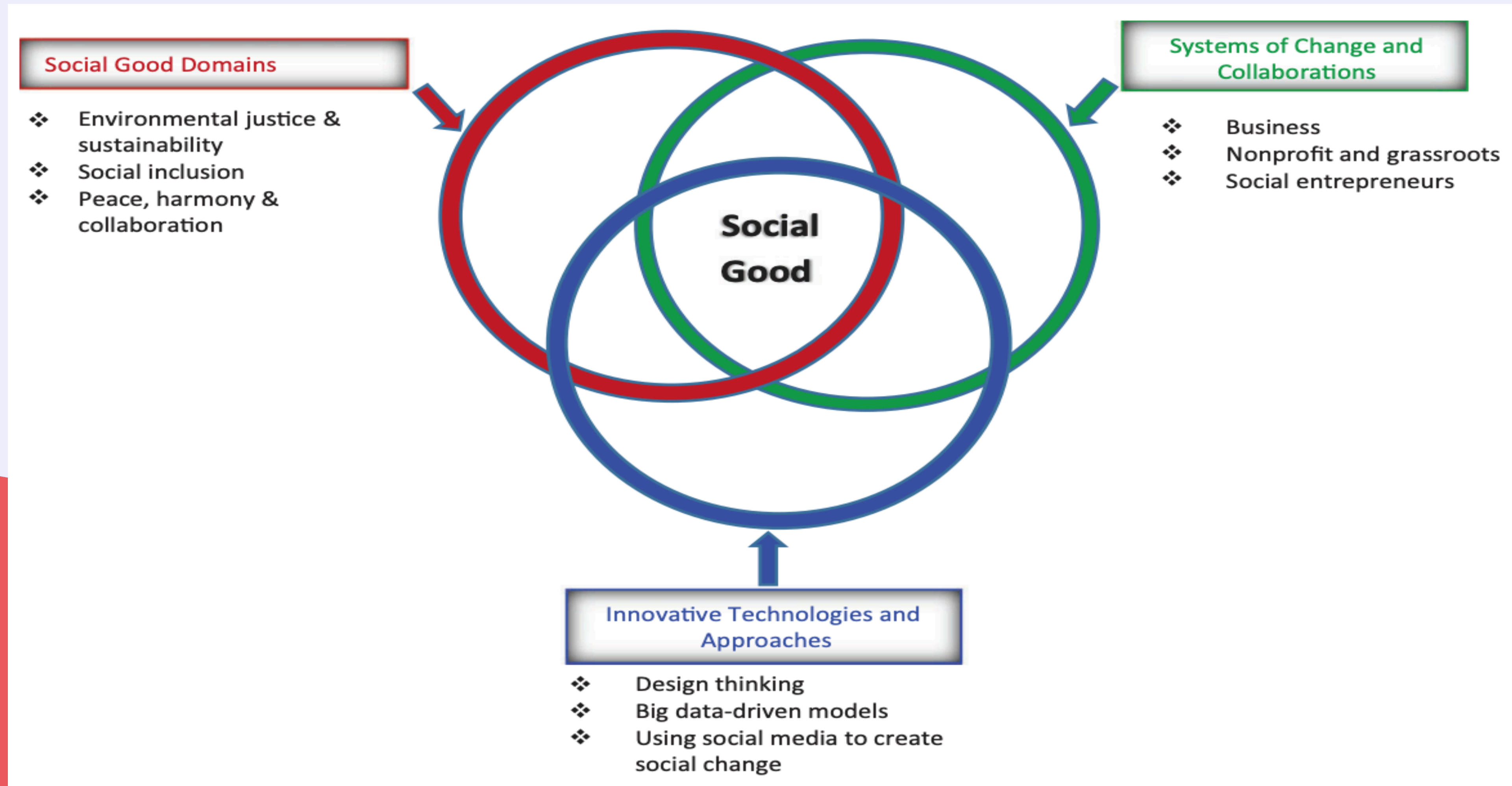
Technological innovations over the ages have brought major welfare gains in the form of better and longer life as well as higher incomes and extended leisure.

In our age, frontier technologies such as the Internet of Things, smart robotics, automation, and artificial intelligence will boost productivity growth, raise prosperity and replace mundane or dangerous tasks.

They have the potential to do good across a wide range of domains, from **healthcare** to **education**.

Do Good. Do Better.

Technology and social good



Source Mor Barak (2020)

**However, sometimes the intersection is
missing...**

Philosophical Reflections on Technology

- Karl Jaspers: “The spirit that has brought forth technology must contain within itself that which brings what has been created back into its order.” = a spirit of technological purposefulness, not only technological innovations for its own sake...
- Martin Heidegger:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4WK8PJvkzG0&t=164s> (min 10:10 - 12:35)

On Artificial Intelligence as
an example

Philosophical Reflection on AI

- Food for thought: Interview with Dani Rodrick (EL PAÍS):

“Interviewer: We are facing a technological revolution with Artificial Intelligence. How will it affect us?

Rodrik: It is very difficult to make predictions, but what is certain is that it is going to have tremendous consequences. We must not be technological determinists and make the same mistake we made with globalization, which was to say that it's something that falls out of the sky and we can't do anything about it, that we can't shape it and that everybody must adapt. I think we are going to make the same mistake with AI and the digital revolution by saying it's something we can't control. Society and the labor market will have to adapt. We will all have to acquire new skills, but it's also in our hands to shape and regulate AI and if we don't do that, if we don't think it through, the consequences are going to be quite undesirable.”

- Underlying question: Is AI a process or a project?

“...algorithms might gain authority because we will learn from experience to trust them on more and more issues and will gradually lose our ability to make decisions for ourselves. Just think of the way that within a mere two decades, billions of people have come to entrust the Google search algorithm with one of the most important tasks of all: searching for relevant and trustworthy information. We no longer search for information. Instead, we google. And as we increasingly rely on Google for answers, so our ability to search for information by ourselves diminishes. Already today, ‘truth’ is defined by the top results of the Google search.” (Yuval Harari)

=== **What about Chat GPT?**

Philosophical Reflection on AI (2)

Yuval Harari, 21 lessons for the 21st century:

“The danger is that if we invest too much in developing AI and too little in developing human consciousness, the very sophisticated artificial intelligence of computers might only serve to empower the natural stupidity of humans. To avoid such outcomes, for every dollar and every minute we invest in improving artificial intelligence, it would be wise to invest a dollar and a minute in advancing human consciousness.”

**What are the impacts of
technology on jobs, work, and
people's lives prospects?**

What do you think? ... and what does it mean?

"The factory of the future will have only two employees, a **man** and a **dog**. The man will be there to feed the dog. The dog will be there to keep the man from touching the equipment."

Warren Bernis



Changing jobs landscape

2022 Skills Outlook

Growing

- 1 Analytical thinking and innovation
- 2 Active learning and learning strategies
- 3 Creativity, originality and initiative
- 4 Technology design and programming
- 5 Critical thinking and analysis
- 6 Complex problem-solving
- 7 Leadership and social influence
- 8 Emotional intelligence
- 9 Reasoning, problem-solving and ideation
- 10 Systems analysis and evaluation



COMMITTED TO
IMPROVING THE STATE
OF THE WORLD

Declining

- 1 Manual dexterity, endurance and precision
- 2 Memory, verbal, auditory and spatial abilities
- 3 Management of financial, material resources
- 4 Technology installation and maintenance
- 5 Reading, writing, math and active listening
- 6 Management of personnel
- 7 Quality control and safety awareness
- 8 Coordination and time management
- 9 Visual, auditory and speech abilities
- 10 Technology use, monitoring and control



Social Media...